

A Brilliant \$20,000,000/Month Shopify Niche Store

Channel: Arie Scherson · Published: Sep 24, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=n9LSojeTxqs> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Smooch is a Shopify beauty brand pulling \$20M+/month with 4.7M monthly visitors and 139% growth, succeeding through continuous product innovation, irresistible bundle offers, and a full-funnel Meta ads strategy running 1,900 active ads simultaneously.

Contents

-  Brand Overview: Smooch's Scale & Growth
-  Best-Selling Product & Offer Structure
-  Product Innovation Strategy
-  Meta Ads Strategy & Ad Volume
-  Bottom-of-Funnel Ad Examples
-  Top-of-Funnel Storytelling Ads
-  Multi-Funnel & Multi-Page Ad Approach
-  Sponsor: Ship Velocity

Brand Overview: Smooch's Scale & Growth 0:21

- Smooch is a Shopify-native beauty brand competing with major players like Elf Cosmetics
- **~4.7 million monthly visitors** to the store at time of recording
- Growing at over **100% year-over-year** — specifically cited at **139% growth** later in the video
- Majority of traffic comes from the United States, with a significant portion from the United Kingdom
- Arie describes it as possibly "one of the best branded stores on Shopify right now"
- Host background for context:
 - Arie runs his own e-commerce brand doing ~\$500K/month
 - Also runs an agency and community called Akemi, spending \$10M/year in ad spend
 - Akemi holds a top-ranked agency partner status on the platform

Best-Selling Product & Offer Structure 1:4

- The current top-selling product is a **color-adapting foundation** (shade-matching/color-changing formula)
- On the surface it appears simple — the power comes entirely from marketing and offer construction
- **The bundle offer breakdown:**

- Buy 2 bottles
- Receive a free Smooch blender/mixer tool
- Receive a free surprise gift
- Free shipping — for only \$10 extra
- The offer is framed as a no-brainer: why buy one when you can get two plus all these extras for a small upcharge?
- The offer is available as a **subscription**, making the one-time purchase comparatively more expensive — incentivizing recurring revenue
- Additional conversion elements on the page:
 - **Scarcity indicator** — signals limited stock
 - **Money-back guarantee** — addresses purchase hesitation common in online shopping
 - Customer testimonials displayed immediately after
- Arie's assessment: the page masterfully combines direct-response marketing, offer building, scarcity, product design, and branding all in one place

Product Innovation Strategy 2:10

- Smooch's original viral product was a **peel-off lip tint/stain**
 - Currently searched **165,000 times per month**
 - Has plateaued in trend growth — a mature but stable category
- Rather than relying solely on their original hero product, they continuously expand into new categories:
 - **Peptide serums** added to the lineup
 - **Collagen face-tightening masks** (previously covered on Arie's channel)
 - **Color-adapting foundation** — their current breakout product
- Key strategic insight:
 - They build a loyal subscriber base across multiple products
 - They consistently ride new product trend waves
 - Innovation is in both formulation and branding

The real moat isn't just great marketing — it's pairing great marketing with relentless product innovation and an expanding loyal customer base.

Meta Ads Strategy & Ad Volume 3:16

- Smooch runs **1,900 active Meta ads simultaneously** at time of recording
 - This count is active ads only — does not include previously tested and paused creatives
- Arie is a self-described Meta ads enthusiast and highlights this as a primary growth driver
- Key structural strategy: **advertising from multiple different Facebook/Instagram pages**

- Pages identified include: "Korean Beauty Tips," "Cosmetic Times," and their main brand page
- This is a strategy Arie also uses for his own brand
- Allows them to reach different audience segments with different brand voices
- The highest-impression ads are treated as the best performers — Arie uses impression volume as a proxy for ad effectiveness

Bottom-of-Funnel Ad Examples 6:38

- Short, direct ads — one example is only **8 seconds long**
- Style is similar to TikTok-native content: fast, product-forward, price-focused
- These ads show the product and immediately highlight the value/price — designed to trigger impulse purchase
- Another bottom-of-funnel example: a **Prime Day sale ad**
 - Simple discount-focused creative
 - Targets people who have already visited the site but haven't converted
 - Acts as a retargeting nudge with an added purchase incentive
- Important caveat from Arie:
 - You **cannot scale** using only bottom-of-funnel ads
 - BOFU ads only reach people who already know the product
 - Scaling requires feeding the top of funnel to grow the audience pipeline

Top-of-Funnel Storytelling Ads 7:41

- One of their highest-impression ads is a **5-minute long video** — shown at the 63-minute mark internally
- Contrast in ad length: they run both 8-second and 5-minute ads in parallel
- The 5-minute ad uses a **narrative/storytelling hook** with no product mention at the start:
 - Opening scene: a woman runs into her ex-husband at Walmart with the woman he left her for
 - She is 41 years old; she hadn't seen him in 4 years — since he handed her divorce papers after **31 years of marriage**
 - No product is shown or mentioned in the opening
 - The story is designed to emotionally hook older women who may fear similar situations
- After the hook, the story transitions to a **pre-landing page** (an editorial-style page on "Cosmetic Times")
 - This page provides valuable editorial content
 - It then drives traffic to the main product landing page
- Why this works (Arie's analysis):
 - Captures attention from people who have never heard of the brand
 - Brings in people who weren't even considering buying a product like this

- The multi-step funnel (story → editorial pre-lander → product page) guides cold audiences through a persuasion journey
- Combining TOFU storytelling with BOFU direct response creates compounding growth

Multi-Funnel & Multi-Page Ad Approach 9:11

- Smooch's full ad ecosystem combines:
 - **Bottom-of-funnel** short-form direct ads
 - **Top-of-funnel** long-form narrative story ads
 - Ads run from **multiple brand pages** (not just their own)
 - Traffic routed through **multiple different conversion funnels** — not a single landing page
- The pre-lander / editorial page (e.g., Cosmetic Times) is a key intermediate step for cold audiences
- The diversity of creative and funnel paths allows for a more **personalized customer experience**
- Arie emphasizes that "funnel diversity" is just as important as creative diversity — a point he says many marketers overlook
- All elements are described as cohesive and visually consistent — "beautiful and very congruent"
- Final growth stat reiterated: **139% growth** at their current scale is described as "unbelievable"

Sponsor: Ship Velocity 4:0

- Sponsor is **Ship Velocity**, a fulfillment/logistics company for e-commerce brands
- Founded/co-owned by Arie's close friend Tanner, who has a direct e-commerce background
- Key differentiators vs. typical 3PLs:
 - **No storage fees**
 - **No software fees**
 - 1–3 day shipping delivery windows
 - Average savings of **at least 30% on delivery costs** for brands they work with
 - Direct relationship with delivery partners (not a middleman abstraction)
- Arie frames the 30% cost reduction as a near-equivalent margin improvement
- Positioned as a strategic partner, not just a vendor — they provide resources and growth support
- CTA: book a call via the link in the video description; they will provide a quote even if not a fit